

0.0.1 The Stilling of Thoughts vitakkasaṇṭhānasuttaṃ

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Savatthi in Jeta's Grove, Anathapindikā's Park. At that place the Auspicious One addressed the bhikkhus: "Bhikkhus." "Bhante," those bhikkhus replied to the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One said this:

evaṃ me sutam: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā sāvatthiyaṃ viharati jetavane anāthapiṇḍikassa ārāme. tatra kho bhagavā bhikkhū āmantesi bhikkhavoti. bhadanteti te bhikkhū bhagavato paccassosum. bhagavā etadavoca:

2. For a bhikkhu devoted to the higher mind, O bhikkhus, he should pay attention to five signs from time to time. What five?

adhicittamanuyuttena bhikkhave bhikkhunā pañca nimittāni kālēna kālaṃ manasikātabbāni. katamāni pañca?

3. Here, O bhikkhus, for a bhikkhu, whatever sign owing to the attention of which there arises evil, unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected

idha bhikkhave bhikkhunā yaṃ nimittaṃ āgamma yaṃ nimittaṃ manasikaroto uppajjanti pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi

with delusion, then, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should attend to some other sign connected with the wholesome. From his [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

4. Just as, O bhikkhus, a skilled carpenter or a carpenter's apprentice having used a very tiny peg, would knock out a grosser peg. So too, O bhikkhus, for a bhikkhu, whatever sign ow-

mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tamhā nimittā aññaṃ nimittaṃ manasikātabbaṃ kusālūpasamhitam. tassa tamhā nimittā aññaṃ nimittaṃ manasikaroto kusālūpasamhitam, ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti. te abbhataṃ gacchanti. te saṃ pahānā ajjhatameva cittaṃ santitṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti¹, samādhīyati.

seyyathāpi bhikkhave dakkho palagaṇḍo vā palagaṇḍante vāsī vā sukhumāya āṇiyā oḷārikaṃ āṇiṃ

¹hosi - machasaṃ ■

ing to the attention of which there arises evil, unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should attend to some other sign connected with the wholesome. From his [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

abhinīhaneyya² abhinīhareyya abhinivajjeyya³ evameva kho bhikkhave bhikkhuno yaṃ nimittaṃ āgama yaṃ nimittaṃ manasikaroto uppajjanti pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tamhā nimittā aññaṃ nimittaṃ manasikātabbaṃ kusālūpasamhitāṃ. ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi te pahīyanti. te abbhatthaṃ gacchanti. tesāṃ pahānā ajjhattameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi

²abhinīhaneyya - machasaṃ

³abhinivatteyya - machasaṃ

5. If, O bhikkhus, from that bhikkhu's [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should investigate the danger in those thoughts thus: "These thoughts are indeed unwholesome. These thoughts are indeed blameworthy. These thoughts indeed ripen in suffering." Of him investigating the danger of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens

hoti samādhīyati.

tassa ce bhikkhave bhikkhuno tamhā nimittā aññaṃ nimittam manasikaroto kusalūpasamhitam uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam vitakkānaṃ ādīnava upaparikkhitabbo: itipime vitakkā akusalā, itipime vitakkā sāvajjā, itipime vitakkā dukkhavipākāti. tassa tesam vitakkānaṃ ādīnavaṃ upaparikkhato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti. te abbhattham gacchanti, tesam pahānā ajjhat-

it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

6. Just as, O bhikkhus, a woman or man, young in years, a youth, fond of adornments, would be troubled, humiliated and disgusted at the corpse of a snake, a corpse of a dog, or a corpse of a human being strung around his or her neck. So too, O bhikkhus, if from that bhikkhu's [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should investigate the danger in those thoughts thus: "These thoughts are indeed unwholesome. These thoughts are

tameva cittaṃ santitṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

seyyathāpi bhikkhave itthī vā vā puriso vā daharo yuvā maṇḍanakajātiko ahikuṇapena vā kukkurakuṇapena vā manussakuṇapena vā kaṇṭhe āsattena aṭṭīyeyya harāyeyya jiguccheyya, evameva kho bhikkhave tassa ce bhikkhuno tamhāpi⁴ nimittā aññaṃ nimittaṃ manasikaroto kusalūpasamhitam uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam vitakkānaṃ ādīnavo

⁴tamhā va - syā

indeed blameworthy. These thoughts indeed ripen in suffering.” Of him investigating the danger of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

7. If, O bhikkhus, for that bhikkhu investigating the danger of those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should

upaparikkhitabbo: itipime vitakkā akusalā, itipime vitakkā sāvajjā, itipime vitakkā dukkhavipākāti. tassa tesam vitakkānam ādīnavam upaparikkhato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti. te abbhattham gacchanti tesam pahānā ajjhatameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

tassa ce bhikkhave bhikkhuno tesam⁵ vitakkānam ādīnavam upaparikkhato uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mo-

⁵tesampi - machasam

engage in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts. Of him engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

8. Just as, O bhikkhus, a man endowed with eyes wishing not to see forms that have come into his range would close his eyes or would look elsewhere. So too, O bhikkhus, if for that bhikkhu investigating the danger of those thoughts, there still

hūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam⁶ vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāro āpajjitabbo. tassa tesam vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāraṃ āpajjato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti. te abbattham gacchanti. tesam pahānā ajjhatameva cittaṃ santitṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

seyyathāpi bhikkhave cakkhumā puriso āpāthagatānaṃ rūpānaṃ adassana-kāmo assa, so nimīleyya⁷ vā aññena vā apalokeyya. eva-

⁶tesam yeva avi

⁷nimmīleyyā - syā

arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should engage in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts. Of him engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

9. If, O bhikkhus, for that bhikkhu engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with

meva kho bhikkhave tassa ce bhikkhuno tesampi vitakkānaṃ ādinavaṃ upaparikkhato uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāro āpajjitabbo. tassa tesam vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāraṃ āpajjato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi

tassa ce bhikkhave bhikkhuno tesampi vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāraṃ āpajjato uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhi-

hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should pay attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts. Of him paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

10. Just as, O bhikkhus, it might occur to a man moving quickly thus: “Why am I moving quickly? What if I were to move slowly?” While moving slowly it might occur to him thus: “Why am I mov-

tāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam vitakkānaṃ vitakkasaṅkhārasaṅghānaṃ⁸ manasi kātabbaṃ tassa tesam vitakkānaṃ vitakkasaṅkhārasaṅghānaṃ manasikaroto ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti te abbhataṃ gacchanti. tesam pahānā ajjhatameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

seyyathāpi bhikkhave puriso sīghaṃ gac-

⁸vitakka saṅkhāra santhānaṃ - syā. aṭṭhakathā 'tena bhikkhave -pe- mohupasaṃhitāpi' pāṭhoyaṃ marammachāṭṭhasaṅgītipiṭakapotthake na dissate ■

ing slowly? What if I were to stand still?” While standing still it might occur to him thus: “Why am I standing still? What if I were to sit down?” While sitting down it might occur to him thus: “Why am I sitting down? What if I were to lie down?” Then he lies down. Thus, O bhikkhus, that man having left behind grosser and grosser postures, would fashion subtler and subtler postures. So too, O bhikkhus, if for that bhikkhu engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should pay attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts. Of him paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts

cheyya, tassa evamassa: kinnu kho ahaṃ sīghaṃ gacchāmi, yannūnāhaṃ saṇikaṃ gaccheyyanti. so saṇikaṃ gaccheyya. tassa evamassa: kinnu kho ahaṃ saṇikaṃ gacchāmi, yannūnāhaṃ tiṭṭheyyanti. so tiṭṭheyya. tassa evamassa: kinnu kho ahaṃ ṭhito yannūnāhaṃ nisīdeyyanti.,so nisīdeyya. tassa evamassa: kinnu kho ahaṃ nisinno, yannūnāhaṃ nipajjeyyanti. so nipajjeyya. evaṃ hi so bhikkhave puriso oḷārikaṃ oḷārikaṃ iriyāpathaṃ abhinivajjetvā⁹ sukhumaṃ sukhumaṃ iriyāpathaṃ kappeyya. evameva kho bhikkhave tassa ce

⁹abhinissajjetvā - syā

connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

bhikkhuno tesampi vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāraṃ āpajjato uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā tesam vitakkānaṃ vitakkasaṅkhārasaṅṭhānaṃ manasikātabbaṃ. tassa tesam vitakkānaṃ vitakkasaṅkhārasaṅṭhānaṃ manasikaroto ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti te abbhatthaṃ gacchanti. tesam pahānā ajjhatameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

tassa ce bhikkhave

11. If, O bhikkhus, for that bhikkhu paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu, having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, should forcibly restrain, completely crush down, overwhelm mental states with mental states. Of him having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, forcibly restraining, completely crushing down, overwhelming mental states with mental states, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his

bhikkhuno tesampi vitakkānaṃ vitakka-saṅkhārasaṅṭhānaṃ manasikaroto uppaj-janteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā dante'bhidantamādhāya¹⁰ jivhāya tāluṃ āhacca cetasā cittaṃ abhiniggaṇhitabbam abhinippīletabbam abhisantāpetabbam. tassa dante'bhidantamādhāya jivhāya tāluṃ āhacca cetasā cittaṃ abhiniggaṇhato

¹⁰ dantehi dantamādhāya, bahusu. dante + abhidantaṃ + ādhāyāti ṭikāyaṃ padacchedo. dantehīti pa-nettha karaṇattho vutto viya dissati - machasaṃ. dante'bhidantamādhāyāti heṭṭhā dante uparidantaṃ ṭhapetvā aṭṭhakathā -siridhammārāma suddhi■

mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

12. Just as, O bhikkhus, a strong man having siezed a weaker man by the head, or having siezed him by the shoulder, were to forcibly restrain, completely crush, and overwhelm him. So too, O bhikkhus, if for that bhikkhu paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected

abhinippīlayato abhisantāpayato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti. te abbhattham gacchantī. tesaṃ pahānā ajjhatameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

seyyathāpi bhikkhave balavā puriso dubbalataram purisaṃ sīsevā gahetvā khandhe vā gahetvā abhiniggaṇheyya abhinippīleyya abhisantāpeyya, evameva kho bhikkhave tassa ce bhikkhuno tesampi vitakkānaṃ vitakka-saṅkhārasaṅṭhānaṃ manasikaroto uppajjanteva pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpa-

with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu, having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, should forcibly restrain, completely crush down, overwhelm mental states with mental states. Of him having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, forcibly restraining, completely crushing down, overwhelming mental states with mental states, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

13. “From the time, O bhikkhus, for a bhikkhu, whatever sign owing to the atten-

saṃhitāpi mohūpa-saṃhitāpi, tena bhikkhave bhikkhunā dante'bhidantamādhāya jivhāya tāluṃ āhacca cetasā cittaṃ abhiniggaṇhato abhinippīlayato abhisantāpayato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, te pahīyanti. te abbatthaṃ gacchanti. te saṃ pahānā ajjhatameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

yato kho bhikkhave bhikkhuno yaṃ nimittaṃ āgamma yaṃ nimittaṃ manasika-

tion of which there arises evil, unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, that bhikkhu [withdrawing] from that sign, attending to some other sign connected with the wholesome, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

14. also of him investigating the danger of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and disappear, and from their

roto uppajjanti pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi, tassa tamhā nimittā aññaṃ nimittaṃ manasikaroto kusalūpasamhitāṃ ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi te pahīyanti. te abbhatthaṃ gacchanti. tesāṃ pahānā ajjhatameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

tesampi vitakkānaṃ ādīnavāṃ upaparikhato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi te pahīyanti. te abbhatthaṃ gacchanti te-

abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

15. also of him engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

16. also of him paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they

saṃ pahānā ajjhat-tameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

tesampi vitakkānaṃ asati amanasikāraṃ āpajjato ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi te pahīyanti. te abbhatthaṃ gacchanti tesam pahānā ajjhat-tameva cittaṃ santiṭṭhati sannisīdati ekodi hoti samādhīyati.

tesampi vitakkānaṃ vitakkasaṅkhārasanthānaṃ manasikaroto ye pāpakā akusalā vitakkā chandūpasamhitāpi dosūpasamhitāpi mohūpasamhitāpi te pahīyanti. te abbhat-

disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

17. also of him having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, should forcibly restraining, completely crushing down, overwhelming mental states with mental states, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

18. this is called, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu who is the master of the pathways of thoughts. Whichever thoughts

thaṃ gacchanti te-
saṃ pahānā ajjhat-
tameva cittaṃ san-
tiṭṭhati sannisīdati
ekodi hoti samādhī-
yati.

dante'bhīdantamā-
dhāya¹¹ jivahāya tā-
luṃ āhacca cetasa
cittaṃ abhiniggaṇ-
hato abhinippīlayato
abhisantāpayato ye
pāpakā akusalā vi-
takkā chandūpasam-
hitāpi dosūpasam-
hitāpi mohūpasam-
hitāpi te pahīyanti.
te abbhatthaṃ gac-
chanti tesam pahānā
ajjhattameva cittaṃ
santiṭṭhati sannisī-
dati ekodi hoti samā-
dhiyati.

ayaṃ vuccati bhik-
khava bhikkhu vaṣi

¹¹ dantehi dantamādhāya - syā,
machasaṃ ■

he wishes to think, it is just those thoughts that he thinks. Whichever thoughts he does not wish to think, it is just those thoughts that he does not think. He has utterly severed thirsting, disjoined the fetters, and rightly breaking through to conceit, has made an end of suffering.”

19. This is what the Auspicious One said. Delighted, those bhikkhus rejoiced in the Auspicious One’s words.

vitakkapariyāyapa-
thesu: yaṃ vitakkaṃ
ākaṅkhissati taṃ vi-
takkaṃ vitakkessati,
yaṃ vitakkaṃ nākaṅ-
khissati na taṃ vi-
takkaṃ vitakkessati,
acchecchi taṇhaṃ,
vāvattayi¹² saṃyoja-
naṃ, sammā mānā-
bhisamayā antama-
kāsi dukkhassāti.

idamavoca bhagavā.
attamanā te bhikkhū
bhagavato bhāsitaṃ
abhinanduntī.

¹²vivantayi - machasaṃ

